The Planting Project

Ten pairs, ten herbs, and no end date. Pairs grow a herb from seed and look after it together for as long as you like, and once it is big enough, they cook with it at home. It teaches responsibility and care: looking after something that depends on you.

Before you start. This project needs a little preparation and possibly a modest spend on compost and seeds; everything else is ready. Tell parents or carers in advance that pairs will bring a small amount of homegrown herb home to cook with, and that an adult should help or supervise in the kitchen.

What you need

Part	What it is	What to do
The slides	One deck for the whole project	Open it in each session; the run sheet below says which slides
The tracker	One spreadsheet, one tab per pair	Print a tab per pair, or share it digitally
Page 2 of this pack	The shopping list, the ten herbs and a checklist	Order or gather everything at least a week before the first session

How it runs

When	What happens	Slides
First session	Introduce the project and why you are doing it. Put students in pairs and give each pair its herb. Pairs research their herb (depth, light, watering, how long it takes to germinate) and agree a plan for sharing the work.	1 to 7
Same session	Planting. Each pair fills a labelled pot with compost, moistens it, sows seeds at the right depth for their herb, chooses a spot with good light and records the planting date.	8
Every week after that	A short check-in each week. Pairs check whether the compost is dry, water carefully, look for shoots, thin out crowded seedlings and log the week in their tracker tab. A photo each week makes the share at the end easier.	9 and 10
When there is enough to harvest	The family cooking challenge, at home. Pairs take only what they need, wash it, and use their herb in a dish they cook for the people at home with an adult helping. They photograph the finished dish.	11
The session after the cooking	Share and reflect. Pairs show their photo and tell the form what they made, who they cooked for, what went well and what they learned about growing things and cooking for others.	12
After that	Pairs keep looking after their herb for as long as you like. If they only pick a few leaves at a time, it keeps growing, so it can stay on the windowsill all year.	

Setting up pairs

- Each pair looks after one herb for the whole project and is responsible for it from the day they sow it.
- Pairs share the watering and checking between them; the plan they write in the first session says who does what.
- Naming the plant is optional, and pairs often take more care of a plant once it has a name.
- Some herbs grow much faster than others, so tell the form early that a slow start is not a failed pot. Rosemary, thyme and parsley are slow from seed, so a small plant keeps those pairs on track.

Before you begin: what to gather

Most of this is inexpensive and easy to find at a supermarket or garden centre. Order or gather it at least a week before your first session, so the seeds and compost have time to arrive.

Item	Quantity	Notes
Small plant pots, or a divided seed tray	10	One per pair. Around 8 to 10cm wide is plenty for a herb.
Multi-purpose or seed compost	1 large bag	Enough to fill ten pots, with a little spare for topping up.
Seed packets, one per herb	10 packets	See the herb list below. Garden centres and supermarkets both stock these.
Plant labels, or masking tape and a pen	10	So each pair can mark their pot with their herb and the planting date.
Watering can or spray bottle	1 or 2, shared	A spray bottle gives more control for younger pairs and delicate seedlings.
Saucers or a tray to catch drips	10, or 1 large tray	Protects windowsills and shelves. Worth checking with site staff first.
A sunny windowsill or shelf	Space for 10 pots	Most of these herbs want good light. Group the pots together if space is tight.
The tracker	Printed, or shared digitally	One tab per pair. The_Planting_Project_Tracker.xlsx.

The ten herbs

Allocate one herb per pair. Each herb is listed with a simple dish it suits, as a starting point for the family cooking challenge; pairs are not limited to these.

Herb	A dish it suits	Herb	A dish it suits
Italian basil	Pesto and pasta	Coriander	Salsas and curries
Thai basil	Stir-fries and noodles	Flat-leaf parsley	Garnish and tabbouleh
Rosemary	Roast potatoes	Thyme	Roast chicken and soup
Peppermint	Tea and fresh salads	Common chives	Scrambled eggs
Oregano	Pizza and tomato sauce	Dill	Dill potatoes and fish

Checklist

- ☐ Pots or trays gathered
- ☐ Compost gathered
- ☐ Seeds for all ten herbs
- ☐ Labels, or tape and a pen
- ☐ Watering can or spray bottle
- ☐ Windowsill or shelf space agreed with site staff
- ☐ Tracker printed or shared with the form
- ☐ Pairs decided and a herb given to each
- ☐ Parents or carers told about the cooking challenge

> ***Great teamwork, real responsibility, and something thoughtful for the people they love. Enjoy it.***